Ablation studies

Learn to understand, design, build, test and explain AI systems responsibly.

Project: Reproducible AI Research Study

TEACHER GUIDE · 1 OF 9

Prepare the purpose, prerequisites and materials

> Prepare Ablation studies: check the target, prerequisites, resources and adaptable teaching schedule.

Teach the learning cycle

Primary target: Explain the **mechanism** and terminology of **ablation** studies

Session · Sequence and minutes · Resources

> **Session:** Session 1 · Understand · 45 min
>
> **Sequence and minutes:** 0–7: recall and prerequisite; 7–15: inspect the concrete case and predict; 15–30: teacher models the worked trace; 30–40: learners explain a step using the text and visual; 40–45: check the core idea.
>
> **Resources:** Use Your mission, Notice the evidence, See how it works, Words that unlock the idea and Follow a worked example; record the brief recall in the workbook.

> **Session:** Session 2 · Practise · 45 min
>
> **Sequence and minutes:** 0–5: retrieve the procedure; 5–15: W2 completion practice; 15–23: explain and check with a partner; 23–30: each learner answers the misconception check; 30–40: targeted reteaching or a harder variation; 40–45: prepare the investigation.
>
> **Resources:** Use Find and repair a mistake, Practise together and Run the investigation, with workbook W2 and Individual reasoning check.

> **Session:** Session 3 · Investigate and transfer · 45 min
>
> **Sequence and minutes:** 0–5: retrieve the decision rule; 5–20: investigate or trace; 20–30: start the independent case; 30–38: connect the project; 38–43: act on feedback; 43–45: plan the return check.
>
> **Resources:** Use Run the investigation, Build your understanding, Connect your project and Show what you know. Reserve further time for the full task set. Use a code example only where one is actually supplied.

This is a starting allocation of 135 minutes, not a validated duration. Preserve all named topics. Schedule extra time for connected examples, the full investigation, independent cases and project building.

Repeated copies of a case share one recorded attempt; they are not new **evidence**.

Retrieval answer guidance

Multiple comparisons

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from Multiple comparisons. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

Look for: Explain the **mechanism** and terminology of multiple comparisons

Reference example, not the only acceptable wording: Teacher explanation: Testing many hypotheses creates more chances for false discoveries. A family rule must be specified before selecting attractive p-values.

For this exercise use Bonferroni:family alpha .05 divided by number of tests m; reject each test when its valid p-value is at most .05/m. This controls the family error by a bound without requiring independent tests.

Effect size and practical importance

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from Effect size and practical importance. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

Look for: Explain the **mechanism** and terminology of effect size and practical importance

Reference example, not the only acceptable wording: Teacher explanation: Effect size describes magnitude on a stated scale. Practical importance depends on task requirements, not merely a nonzero difference.

For paired response durations compute baseline minus candidate per case and average the differences. Positive means faster candidate. Compare with a prespecified minimum useful gain.

Confounders and controls

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from Confounders and controls. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

Look for: Explain the **mechanism** and terminology of confounders and controls

Reference example, not the only acceptable wording: Teacher explanation: A confounder changes alongside the intended factor and can offer another explanation. Controls aim to isolate the proposed **mechanism**.

For a toy comparison vary only retrieval method while holding corpus, queries, cutoff and relevance rubric fixed. Randomise or counterbalance order when order effects matter.

Compact alternative: two 45-minute sessions for the core explanation and W1–W5 only. The main plan uses three sessions; schedule further time for the complete investigation, project, visual journey and any code examples. **Ablation** removes a component to investigate its contribution under a controlled comparison. **Interaction**s can make contributions depend on other components.

Use the supplied constructed scenarios to make the **mechanism** inspectable. Collect W4 before sharing solutions.

Students should name intermediate **evidence** and limitations; classroom pacing and learning effectiveness remain unvalidated.

Outcomes

Explain the **mechanism** and terminology of **ablation** studies

Apply the stated procedure to a new case with a traceable result

Identify an assumption or limitation and design a revealing follow-up

Preparation

Lesson and workbook; paper and pencil

Calculator and optional local Python 3 for arithmetic; no live API or private data

Prepare the fresh retry separately and withhold its solution until after collection

Prerequisite answer

A result depends on the **input**s, procedure and conditions that produced it. Preserve data roles and distinguish observed outcomes from **prediction**s or unmeasured conditions.

If the prior concept cannot be explained, use a short retrieval activity before this chapter.

End goal for the pictorial case

Explain **ablation** studies using the records and boundaries of this fictional investigation.

This added worked case illustrates the week's main idea. Retain all original and connected topics; schedule its practice within the teaching cycle.

TEACHER GUIDE · 2 OF 9

Explain and model the mechanism

> Model Ablation studies using the supplied case, labelled mechanism and reasoning. Make the scope of each conclusion explicit.

Ablation removes a component to investigate its contribution under a controlled comparison. **Interaction**s can make contributions depend on other components.

Explain Ablation studies · 1

Begin by writing the question the procedure is intended to answer. Identify the information already supplied, the information it will produce and the information still missing.

These are constructed classroom examples; they do not require live accounts, private records or an external service. Do not treat a plausible explanation as a measured outcome.

Compare full system, without retrieval and without validation on identical cases and scoring. Hold other settings fixed; record changed failure categories, not just totals.

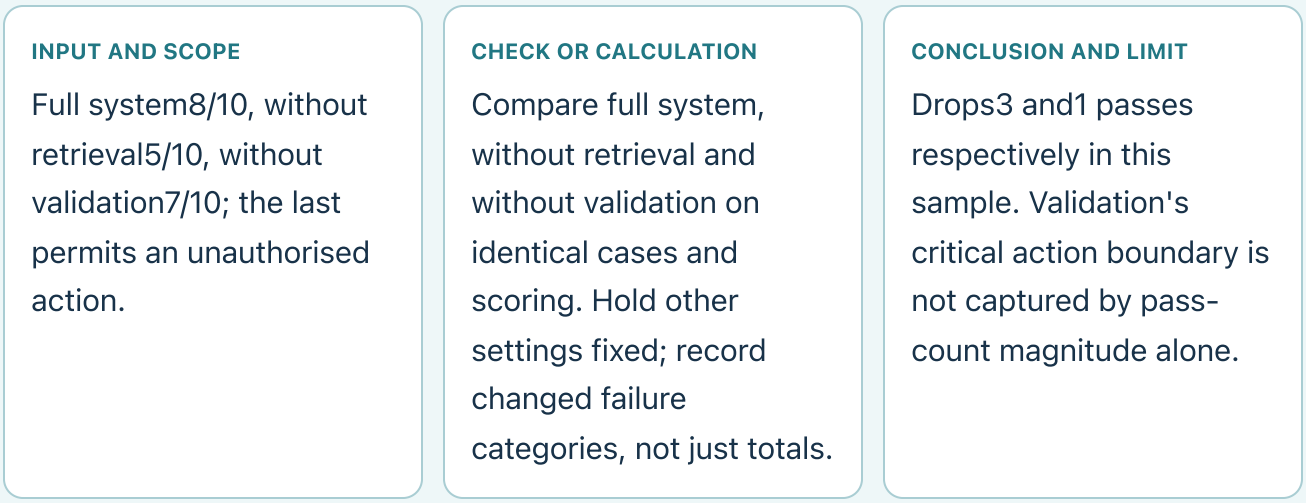
Explain Ablation studies · 2

Before applying the procedure, write its units, denominator or decision boundary where relevant. A partner should be able to repeat each step using the same **input**s.

If a required **input** is absent or violates the stated contract, record that condition explicitly instead of quietly replacing it with a convenient value.

Term	Meaning
Ablation	Removing or disabling a component in a comparison
Conditional contribution	An effect given the other components
Interaction	An effect depending on another factor's setting

Ablation studies — evidence trace



The figure connects this chapter's worked input, declared procedure and result. Read the complete worked reasoning for qualifiers and intermediate steps; the abbreviated labels do not replace that reasoning.

Explain Ablation studies · 3

Guided: Drops3 and1 passes respectively in this sample. Validation's critical action boundary is not captured by pass-count magnitude alone.

Qualification: Removing a component changes a complete procedure; attribution depends on the controlled design and possible **interaction**s.

Exit: accept a concrete variation with its predicted outcome and a stated condition that would challenge the **mechanism**; reject a claim resting on unmeasured **evidence**.

Model the reasoning aloud

Use the complete worked example below before asking learners to complete W2. Reveal a small part, invite a **prediction**, then explain the deciding step.

These teacher notes contain solutions; do not reveal the independent case answer during modelling.

Full system8/10, without retrieval5/10, without validation7/10; the last permits an unauthorised action.

Drops3 and1 passes respectively in this sample. Validation's critical action boundary is not captured by pass-count magnitude alone.

Model the reasoning aloud · 4

Compare the intermediate **evidence** with the final statement. Explain why each number or decision follows from the stated **input**s.

The conclusion belongs to this scenario and procedure; changing the **input**s, evaluation population or authority can change what it establishes. Retain the raw record so a later revision can be compared honestly.

Thinking move	Teacher prompt
Plan	What is given? What is the question? Which procedure fits these facts?
Do	Point to each input and intermediate step in the worked trace. Name the rule that allows the next step.
Check	Does the output answer the question? Which assumption or limitation prevents a larger claim?

Use the diagram and verbal explanation together. Ask learners to match a sentence to a specific visual step; do not assign learners fixed visual or auditory learning styles.

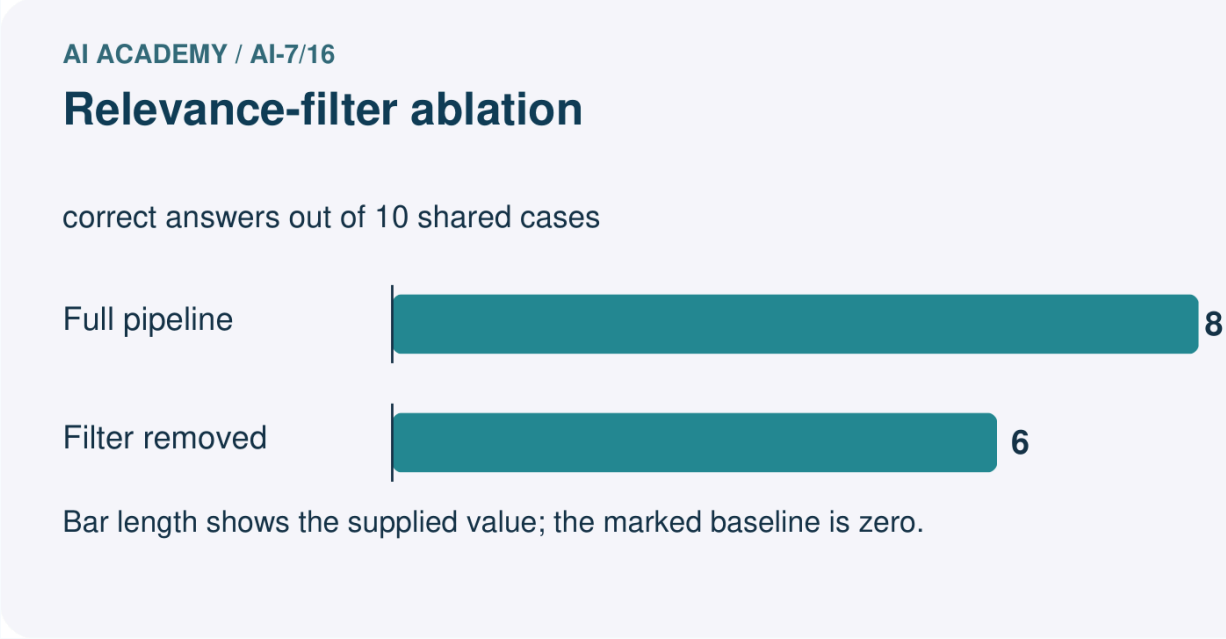
A pictorial worked case: Ablation studies

Remove one component at a time. A retrieval pipeline has search plus a relevance filter. A team tests the filter's contribution.

The facts we will use

Supplied facts

Full pipeline: 8/10 correct. Filter removed: 6/10 on the same cases, with all other settings fixed.



Follow the labelled picture with the matching explanation. Open the vector diagram

AI ACADEMY / AI-7/16

Ablation studies

Start with the supplied facts

Follow each arrow. Ask which fact allows the next step.



1. Name the component

The relevance filter is the single declared change.



2. Run the ablation

Remove only the filter and preserve cases and scoring.



3. Compare outcomes

Correctness falls from 80% to 60%, two cases in this set.

CHANGE ONE THING

Remove the filter and also change the model version.

Explain the changed result using the matching lesson.

Follow the labelled picture with the matching explanation. Open the vector diagram

Read the picture one step at a time

STEP	WHAT HAPPENS AND WHY
1. Name the component	The relevance filter is the single declared change.
2. Run the ablation	Remove only the filter and preserve cases and scoring.
3. Compare outcomes	Correctness falls from 80% to 60%, two cases in this set.

Match each pictured step to the supplied facts. This is a worked teaching case, not an independent assessment.

Why this result follows

Why the result follows

An **ablation** probes a component by removing or changing it while holding the rest fixed. It supports a scoped comparison, not a claim that the component always helps.

What this example does not establish

Keep the stated limit

Interactions and small-sample variability remain; this illustrative difference is not a universal causal estimate.

Change one thing in the pictured case

Change one thing

Change: Remove the filter and also change the model version.

Predicted result

Prediction: The comparison no longer isolates the filter.

Why the result follows

Reason: Two simultaneous changes provide alternative explanations.

Ask while showing the picture

Ask while showing the picture · 5

Cover the result. Ask learners to name the **input**s and predict the next step. Uncover one step, connect the icon to the actual procedure, and explain its **evidence**. Then change the supplied condition and compare.

The picture is a representation; it does not document execution of a real AI model.

Demonstrate and guide practice

> Demonstrate Ablation studies, reduce support deliberately and check individual reasoning before discussing answers.

Time or stage	Teacher action
Session 1: 0–7 minutes	Retrieve the prerequisite; identify the input, procedure and evidence source.
7–18 minutes	Explain See how it works and Words that unlock the idea. Complete W1 with a mechanism-based explanation.
18–32 minutes	Trace the declared procedure and worked case. Complete W2, recording intermediate steps.
32–45 minutes	Discuss the diagram with the worked input; use W3 to distinguish measured claims and limitations.
Session 2: 0–8 minutes	Retrieve the worked reasoning and collect the guided response before discussing it.
8–20 minutes	Compare a proposed boundary variant with the original case; identify what remains fixed.
20–35 minutes	Collect W4 independently. Require the procedure trace and the bounded conclusion.
35–45 minutes	Use W5 and exit responses for feedback. Administer the fresh retry after feedback and preserve both attempts.

Use the worked example in Sections 3 and 6. Collect a **prediction** before revealing its result; ask the learner to point to each intermediate fact.

Provide an **input**/procedure/result/limit frame and a calculator when needed. Ask students to identify the first step before completing the whole trace.

Extension: compare two concrete variants of this **mechanism** while holding unrelated conditions fixed; report both successful and unsuccessful outcomes.

Reduce help deliberately

Completion practice

Completion task: Full system8/10, without retrieval5/10, without validation7/10; the last permits an unauthorised action. Show the intermediate steps and give the conclusion with its scope.

Reasoning to listen for

Teacher check: Teacher explanation: Drops3 and1 passes respectively in this sample. Validation's critical action boundary is not captured by pass-count magnitude alone.

Start by identifying the given **input**s together. Leave the intermediate steps blank. If needed, model one step, then withdraw that help on the next step. Move to a full trace only when the partial trace is understood.

For partners, alternate explainer and checker; collect a response from every learner before discussion.

Individual reasoning check

Use the worked case for **Ablation** studies. Proposed explanation: “The worked result establishes every future case”. Decide whether this explanation is supported.

Point to the step or supplied fact that decides; explain your repair if needed.

Expected repair

Expected correction: Removing a component changes a complete procedure; attribution depends on the controlled design and possible **interaction**s.

Collect explanations, not only yes/no votes. If a misunderstanding is common, re-model the relevant step for the class.

If it affects a few learners, give a short targeted group explanation while others solve a more demanding variation.

Pictorial practice question

Calculate the filter **ablation**’s two rates and count change. Which single component is altered, and why does also changing the model prevent isolating the filter?

Reasoned teacher answer

The relevance filter is the single declared change. Remove only the filter and preserve cases and scoring. Correctness falls from **80%** to **60%**, two cases in this set. Changed case: The comparison no longer isolates the filter.

Two simultaneous changes provide alternative explanations.

Changed-case reasoning: The comparison no longer isolates the filter. Two simultaneous changes provide alternative explanations.

Collect each learner's explanation before discussion. Use the first missing connection between **input**, deciding step and result to choose support. This question is worked-case practice, not fresh mastery **evidence**.

Run the investigation and diagnose misconceptions

> Run the Ablation studies investigation and use the first unsupported step to choose a teaching response.

The worked result establishes every future case: Removing a component changes a complete procedure; attribution depends on the controlled design and possible **interaction**s.

A missing **input** may be replaced without recording the change: A replacement changes the **evidence** or contract. Record the change and its justification; do not silently turn unknown into a measured value.

Repeating an assessed case is new independent **evidence**: A replay checks consistency. An example used for feedback or revision cannot later be described as untouched final evaluation.

Use Section 9 for the **evidence** ledger. Add a boundary or missing-**input** case and record the expected response before checking. More successful repeats of one case do not establish wider coverage.

Match the support to the first error

What the response shows	Next teaching action
Missing or misread facts	Read the case aloud, mark supplied versus unknown facts, and let the learner restate it.
Wrong procedure	Return to the deciding step in the worked case. Contrast it with the proposed incorrect explanation.
Arithmetic or implementation error	Trace intermediate values or lines; preserve the first mismatch and retry that step.
Correct result without a reason	Ask for a trace and a changed case before marking independent understanding.
An unsupported wider claim	Ask which supplied evidence supports the claim and which further observation would be needed.

Offer an oral explanation, drawing, enlarged visual or fewer examples when that removes a reading/writing barrier. Keep the same reasoning goal.

Stretch secure learners by changing a boundary or assumption and asking them to defend the effect, not simply by assigning more of the same questions.

Assess and explain the answers

> Use the Ablation studies questions, teacher keys and criteria after the relevant attempts. Previously discussed cases are practice; protect the separately selected independent task.

Guided and exit questions

Guided: Drops3 and1 passes respectively in this sample. Validation's critical action boundary is not captured by pass-count magnitude alone.

Qualification: Removing a component changes a complete procedure; attribution depends on the controlled design and possible **interaction**s.

Exit: accept a concrete variation with its predicted outcome and a stated condition that would challenge the **mechanism**; reject a claim resting on unmeasured **evidence**.

W1 Explain the mechanism

Workbook question · W1

Explain the weekly **mechanism** in your own words. Use the worked scenario to name its **input**, decision rule and **output**.

Teacher reasoning · W1

Teacher explanation: **Ablation** removes a component to investigate its contribution under a controlled comparison. **Interaction**s can make contributions depend on other components.

Compare full system, without retrieval and without validation on identical cases and scoring. Hold other settings fixed; record changed failure categories, not just totals.

W2 Trace the worked case

Workbook question · W2

Full system8/10, without retrieval5/10, without validation7/10; the last permits an unauthorised action. Show the intermediate steps and give the conclusion with its scope.

Teacher reasoning · W2

Teacher explanation: Drops3 and1 passes respectively in this sample. Validation's critical action boundary is not captured by pass-count magnitude alone.

W3 Audit the limit

Workbook question · W3

A report omits this qualification: Removing a component changes a complete procedure; attribution depends on the controlled design and possible **interaction**s.

Explain how omitting it could change a reader's interpretation, and write an accurate replacement.

Teacher reasoning · W3

Teacher explanation: Removing a component changes a complete procedure; attribution depends on the controlled design and possible **interaction**s.

State the observed result separately from the unverified or out-of-scope claim; preserve the original **evidence** rather than inventing a missing fact.

W4 Apply a new case independently

Workbook question · W4

Full12/15, without A9/15, without B11/15. Compute sample drops and state **interaction** limit.

Teacher reasoning · W4

Teacher explanation: Drops3/15=20 percentage points and1/15≈6.667 points. Effects are conditional on remaining components; not additive universal contributions.

W5 Design a revealing follow-up

Workbook question · W5

For the worked scenario, propose one additional case that could reveal a failure, describe its expected outcome before running it, and explain what would need to remain fixed for a fair comparison.

Do not reuse W4 as a new final test after receiving feedback.

Teacher reasoning · W5

Teacher explanation: Accept a concrete variant of the worked **input** or a missing/conflicting/boundary condition, with an expectation derived from the declared procedure.

Require preserved settings, original **output**s and data roles. Removing a component changes a complete procedure; attribution depends on the controlled design and possible **interaction**s.

The new case should test this particular **mechanism** rather than merely restate the original result.

Independent assessment and fresh retry

Teacher key · Independent assessment and fresh retry

W4: Drops3/15=20 percentage points and1/15≈6.667 points. Effects are conditional on remaining components; not additive universal contributions. Require intermediate reasoning and the stated scope.

Fresh retry: Full9/12, without A6/12, without B8/12. Expected reasoning: Drops25 and8.333 percentage points; keep identical cases and inspect individual failures.

If students need support, record it and reassess with another new case rather than awarding independence to a copied answer.

Assess independent transfer

Independent question · withhold the key

Selected case: Full12/15, without A9/15, without B11/15. Compute sample drops and state **interaction** limit.

Selected case answer

Teacher key · Selected case answer

Teacher explanation: Drops3/15=20 percentage points and1/15≈6.667 points. Effects are conditional on remaining components; not additive universal contributions.

Dimension	Evidence required
Explanation	Names the applicable idea or procedure and ties it to the supplied facts.
Trace and result	Preserves the given inputs and shows the relevant intermediate steps; distinguishes a prediction from an observed execution.
Limits	States the assumptions, missing evidence or conditions under which the result would change.

Teacher key · Selected case answer

Record each dimension as not yet, with support, or independent. Accept a valid alternative procedure with a defensible trace.

Do not penalise an honestly recorded model failure if the learner correctly explains its **evidence** and limits.

Feedback that the learner uses

Name the earliest unsupported step and give one action to repair it. Have the learner make that repair now and explain why. Then assess the relevant skill on a fresh, fully specified case.

Confirm it was not previously practised with feedback; solve and check the new case before assigning it. A follow-up design prompt is a starting brief, not automatically an equivalent test.

TEACHER GUIDE · 6 OF 9

Connect the project, support and next lesson

> Connect Ablation studies to Reproducible AI Research Study, adapt support and plan a later changed-case check.

Add a labelled **ablation** studies **evidence** sheet to Reproducible AI Research Study. Show how you can explain the **mechanism** and terminology of **ablation** studies.

Use the supplied fictional case and keep its **input**s, intermediate steps, calculation or **prediction**, and limitation. Connect this record to last week's record; a matching answer without a trace is insufficient.

Provide an **input**/procedure/result/limit frame and a calculator when needed. Ask students to identify the first step before completing the whole trace.

Extension: compare two concrete variants of this **mechanism** while holding unrelated conditions fixed; report both successful and unsuccessful outcomes.

Next connection: Sensitivity analysis. Preserve the current case record and retrieve its **evidence** boundary before moving on.

Retain the project ledger and assess a changed case after support. Check the relevant prerequisite before carrying this component forward.

Plan the delayed return

Suggested return points in this level: ai-7/17, ai-7/19, ai-7/22. Use actual classroom dates, adjusting for holidays and gaps. One, three and six teaching weeks are scheduling choices, not a claimed optimal spacing.

At a delayed check, ask for the idea from memory and a changed application. Compare with the earlier independent response and record support used.

For a new level, revisit the previous capstone before checking the new prerequisites.

Record	Teacher evidence
Learner code and date	
Concept and case used; prior exposure	
Explanation / trace / limits	
Support and first repair	
Changed case and delayed outcome	
Next teaching action	

Use the **evidence** to choose reteaching or the next step. A completed page, confidence rating or attractive project does not by itself demonstrate understanding.

Project evidence from this case

For the Reproducible AI Research Study, retain an annotated worked trace and the changed-case reasoning. Connect the claim to its records, units and assumptions so another investigator can challenge or reproduce it.

Prepare, teach and assess

> Use this preparation summary alongside the detailed Ablation studies lesson; it is a checklist rather than a replacement for the full sequence.

Teaching target

Teaching target: Explain the **mechanism** and terminology of **ablation** studies

Prepare the labelled worked-case picture, the matching workbook, fictional **input** cards and a place for individual responses. Check a local Python 3 environment before class; have a paper-trace version ready.

Session · Plan · Resources

> **Session:** Session 1 · Understand · 45 min
>
> **Plan:** 0–7: recall and prerequisite; 7–15: inspect the concrete case and predict; 15–30: teacher models the worked trace; 30–40: learners explain a step using the text and visual; 40–45: check the core idea.
>
> **Resources:** Use Your mission, Notice the evidence, See how it works, Words that unlock the idea and Follow a worked example; record the brief recall in the workbook.

> **Session:** Session 2 · Practise · 45 min
>
> **Plan:** 0–5: retrieve the procedure; 5–15: W2 completion practice; 15–23: explain and check with a partner; 23–30: each learner answers the misconception check; 30–40: targeted reteaching or a harder variation; 40–45: prepare the investigation.
>
> **Resources:** Use Find and repair a mistake, Practise together and Run the investigation, with workbook W2 and Individual reasoning check.

> **Session:** Session 3 · Investigate and transfer · 45 min
>
> **Plan:** 0–5: retrieve the decision rule; 5–20: investigate or trace; 20–30: start the independent case; 30–38: connect the project; 38–43: act on feedback; 43–45: plan the return check.
>
> **Resources:** Use Run the investigation, Build your understanding, Connect your project and Show what you know. Reserve further time for the full task set. Use a code example only where one is actually supplied.

Before class, solve the supported practice: Full system8/10, without retrieval5/10, without validation7/10; the last permits an unauthorised action. Show the intermediate steps and give the conclusion with its scope.

Supported practice answer

Reasoned practice answer: Teacher explanation: Drops3 and1 passes respectively in this sample. Validation's critical action boundary is not captured by pass-count magnitude alone.

Check every learner before discussion: Use the worked case for **Ablation** studies. Proposed explanation: “The worked result establishes every future case”. Decide whether this explanation is supported.

Point to the step or supplied fact that decides; explain your repair if needed.

Repair the misconception

Misconception repair: Removing a component changes a complete procedure; attribution depends on the controlled design and possible **interaction**s.

Support without giving away the answer

Support: read the exact case aloud, enlarge the labelled picture, supply **input** cards and model only the first deciding step. Accept a spoken explanation or drawing; retain the reasoning goal.

Extend the reasoning

Extension: Remove the filter and also change the model version. Require a **prediction** and a reason before comparing. Expected result: The comparison no longer isolates the filter.

Reason: Two simultaneous changes provide alternative explanations.

Protect the independent attempt

Independent assessment: withhold the reserved answer until the learner has attempted the

new case. Record support separately from correctness.

Criterion	Not yet	With support	Independent
Explanation	Names an answer without a deciding fact	Uses a hint to link fact and decision	Explains the deciding fact in own words
Trace or test	Cannot connect input and result	Completes steps with prompts	Traces or tests a changed case accurately
Limits and revision	Claims more than evidence supports	Names a limit after a prompt	States a defensible limit and useful next test

Project checkpoint

Project checkpoint: Test changed cases. Keep normal, boundary and failure cases; compare expected and observed results.

Use the weekly teacher answer for topic-specific reasoning. A saved progress tick is an activity record; judge mastery from the learner's explanation and **evidence**.

Use feedback, labs and repair paths

> Use feedback, earlier review and portfolios purposefully. Apply the coding routine only when this lesson has an executable lab.

Use the two formative questions as supported practice, not as independent mastery scores. Discuss the deciding **evidence** rather than accepting a guessed selection.

The feedback comes from the reviewed public worked case. Do not reveal the separately reserved independent teacher answer until the learner has attempted that case.

For later coding lessons

> This week has no code block. Use this routine when a later lesson includes an executable lab.

Ask students to predict before running code. Preserve errors and actual **output**s; collect a changed test and an explanation. The branch-boundary and indexing lessons deliberately include failure cases.

Use the earlier worked-explanation links to address a specific missing building block, then return to the current question. Adapt this suggestion after observing the learner; it is not an automatic diagnosis.

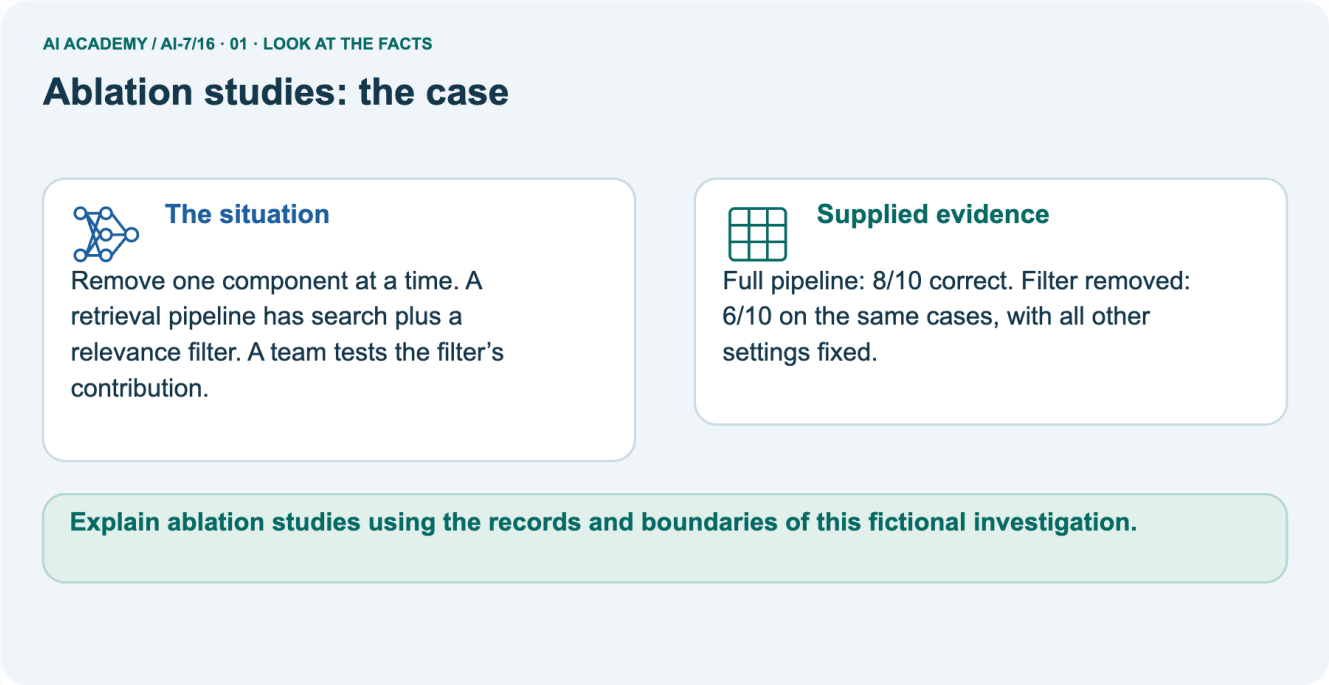
Collect the completed-work portfolio as **evidence**. Record support separately from correctness, and assess explanation, trace/test and limitations. Progress ticks and quiz selections alone do not establish mastery.

Visual concept journey

> Show one Ablation studies graphic at a time, request a prediction and discuss its trace before the independent assessment.

Use one picture at a time. Hide a worked result before asking for a **prediction**, then reveal it for feedback. These are supported teaching cases; retain the separate independent assessment for a fresh first attempt.

01. Ablation studies: the case



Follow the labelled picture with the matching explanation. Open the vector diagram

Remove one component at a time. A retrieval pipeline has search plus a relevance filter. A team tests the filter's contribution. Supplied facts: Full pipeline: 8/10 correct.

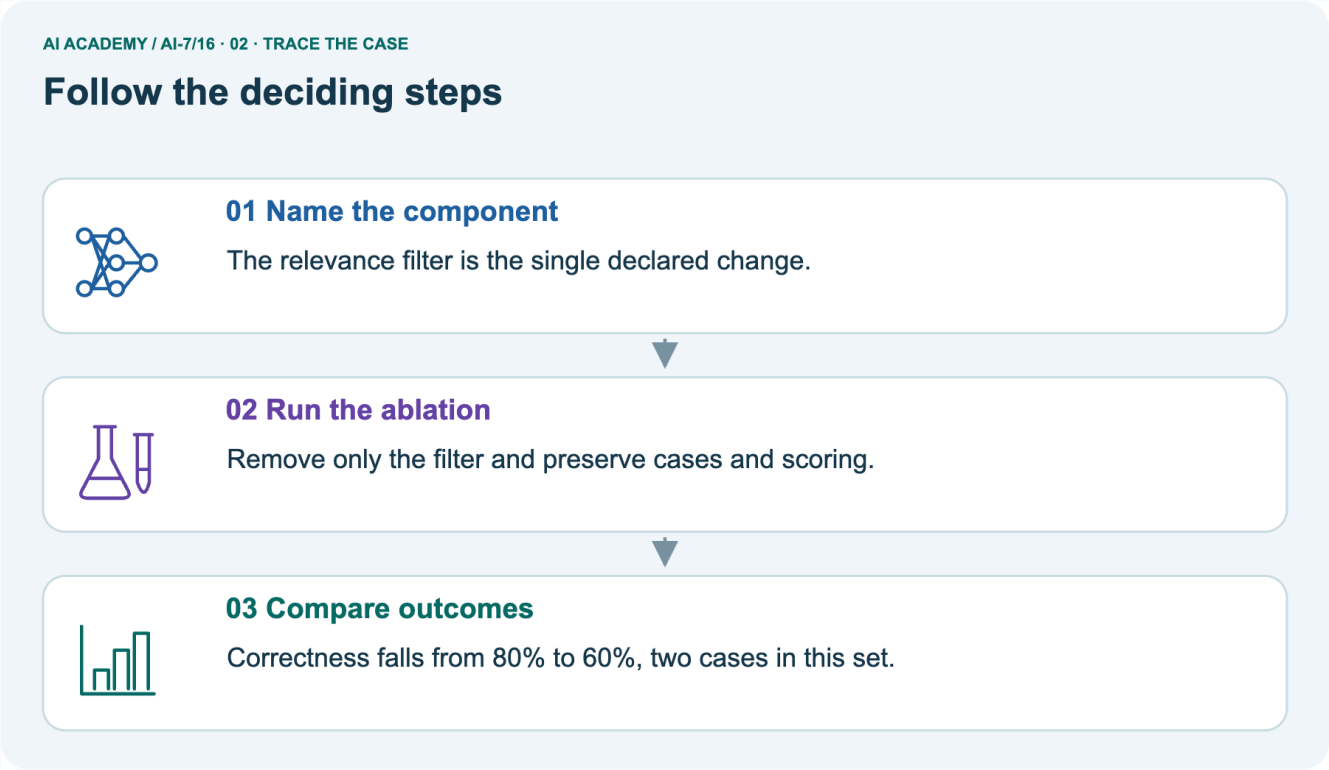
Filter removed: 6/10 on the same cases, with all other settings fixed.

> Point to the given fact that matters most. Explain why it matters.

Discuss while showing the picture

Teacher prompt: Point to the given fact that matters most. Explain why it matters. Ask learners to describe one label or arrow in ordinary words. Use the adjacent transcript if the image is difficult to see.

02. Follow the deciding steps



Follow the labelled picture with the matching explanation. Open the vector diagram

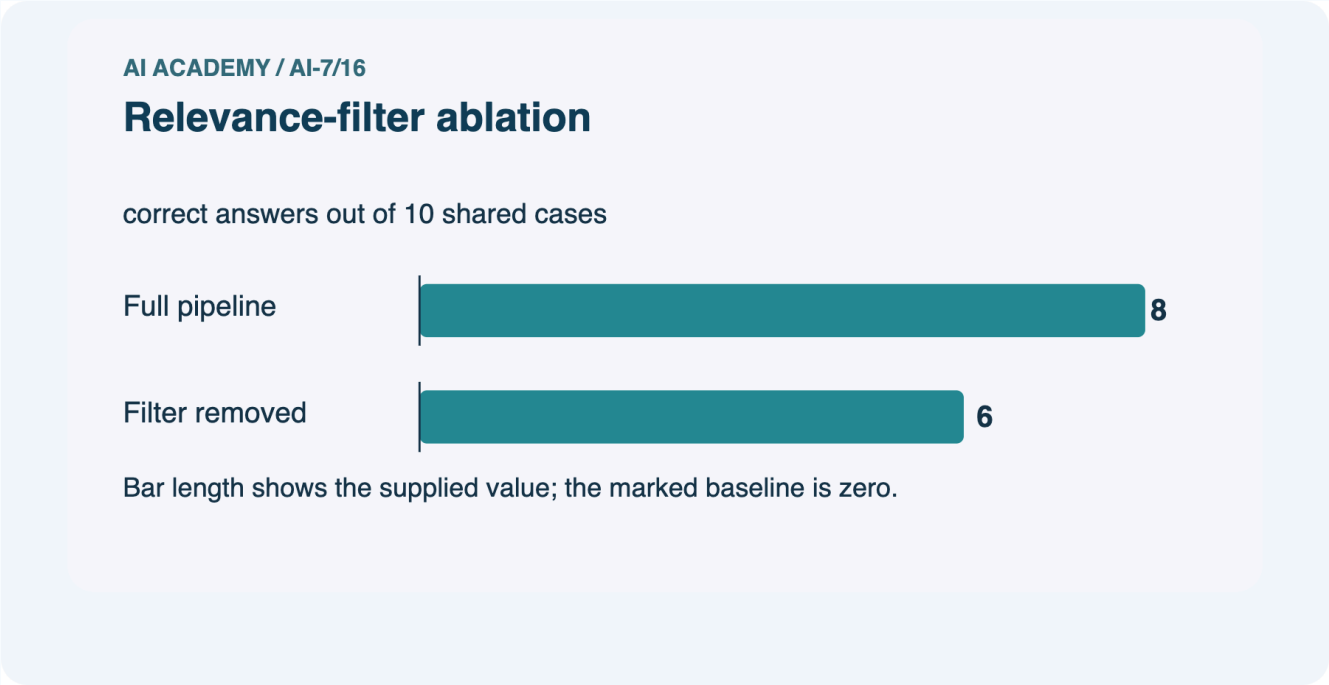
Name the component: The relevance filter is the single declared change. → Run the **ablation**: Remove only the filter and preserve cases and scoring. → Compare outcomes: Correctness falls from **80%** to **60%**, two cases in this set.

Point to each numbered stage and explain which recorded **input** it uses.

Discuss while showing the picture

Teacher prompt: Point to each numbered stage and explain which recorded **input** it uses. Ask learners to describe one label or arrow in ordinary words. Use the adjacent transcript if the image is difficult to see.

03. Relevance-filter ablation



Follow the labelled picture with the matching explanation. Open the vector diagram

Relevance-filter **ablation**. Units: correct answers out of 10 shared cases. Full pipeline: 8. Filter removed: 6.

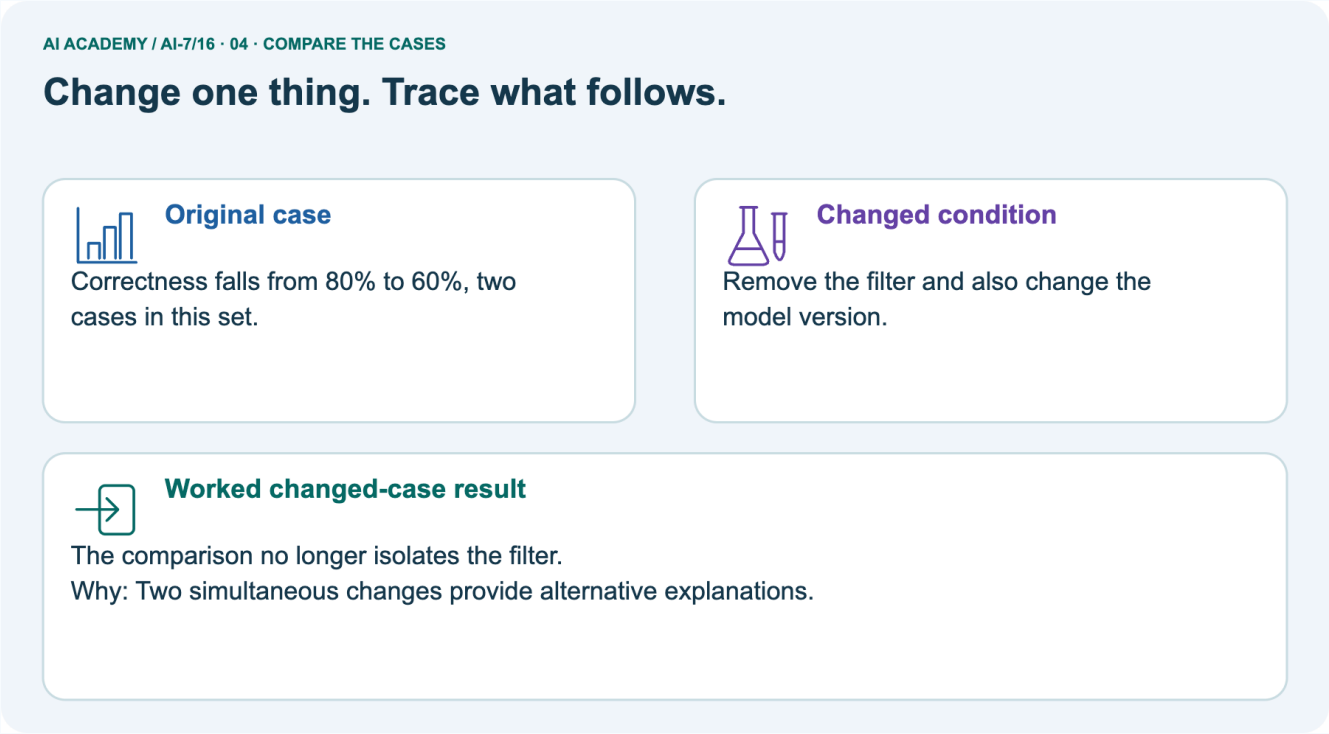
Read the labels and values. Explain the relationship the model shows.

Discuss while showing the picture

Teacher prompt: Read the labels and values. Explain the relationship the model shows. Ask learners to describe one label or arrow in ordinary words. Use the adjacent transcript if the image is difficult to see.

Check row/column meanings, units and denominators before discussing a difference. Supplied toy values are not real class or model results.

04. Change one thing. Trace what follows.



Follow the labelled picture with the matching explanation. Open the vector diagram

Original case: Correctness falls from **80%** to **60%**, two cases in this set. Changed condition: Remove the filter and also change the model version. Expected result: The comparison no longer isolates the filter.

Reason: Two simultaneous changes provide alternative explanations.

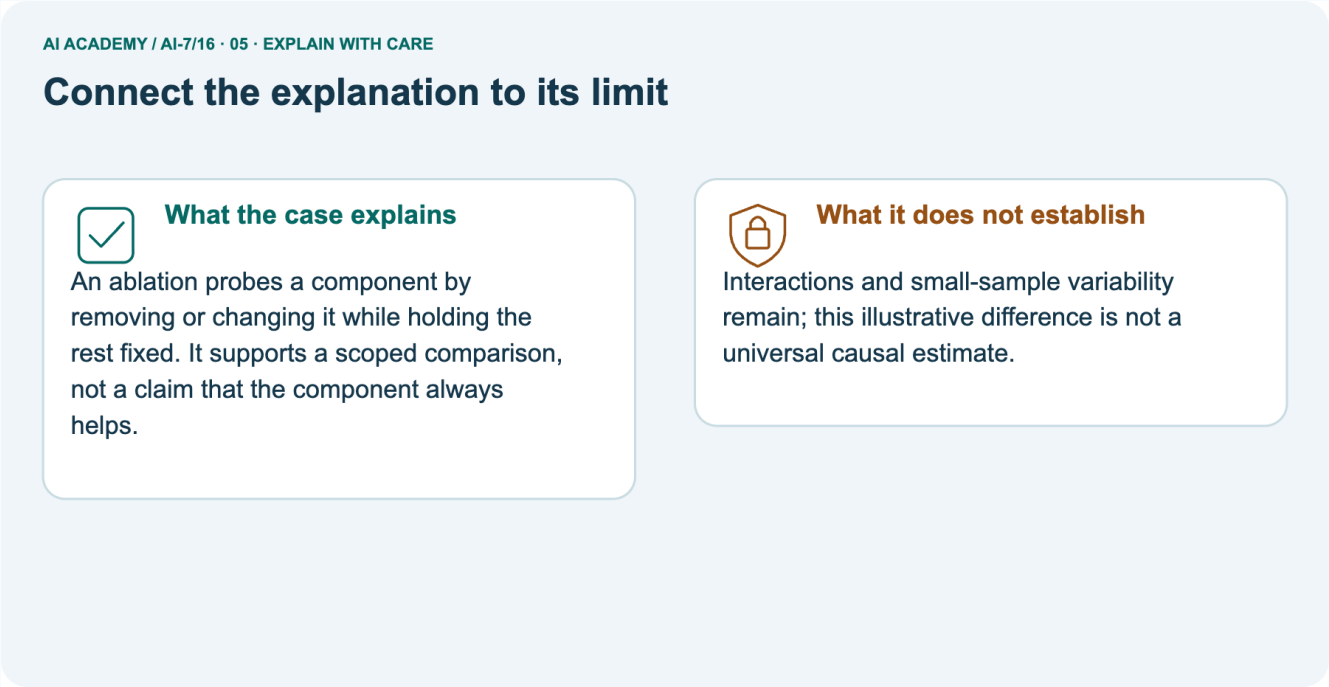
Predict before checking the worked changed-case result. Name what changed and what the supplied facts allow you to conclude.

Discuss while showing the picture

Teacher prompt: Predict before checking the worked changed-case result. Name what changed and what the supplied facts allow you to conclude. Ask learners to describe one label or arrow in ordinary words.

Use the adjacent transcript if the image is difficult to see. Changed-case reasoning: Two simultaneous changes provide alternative explanations.

05. Connect the explanation to its limit



Follow the labelled picture with the matching explanation. Open the vector diagram

An **ablation** probes a component by removing or changing it while holding the rest fixed. It supports a scoped comparison, not a claim that the component always helps.

Limit: **Interaction**s and small-sample variability remain; this illustrative difference is not a universal causal estimate.

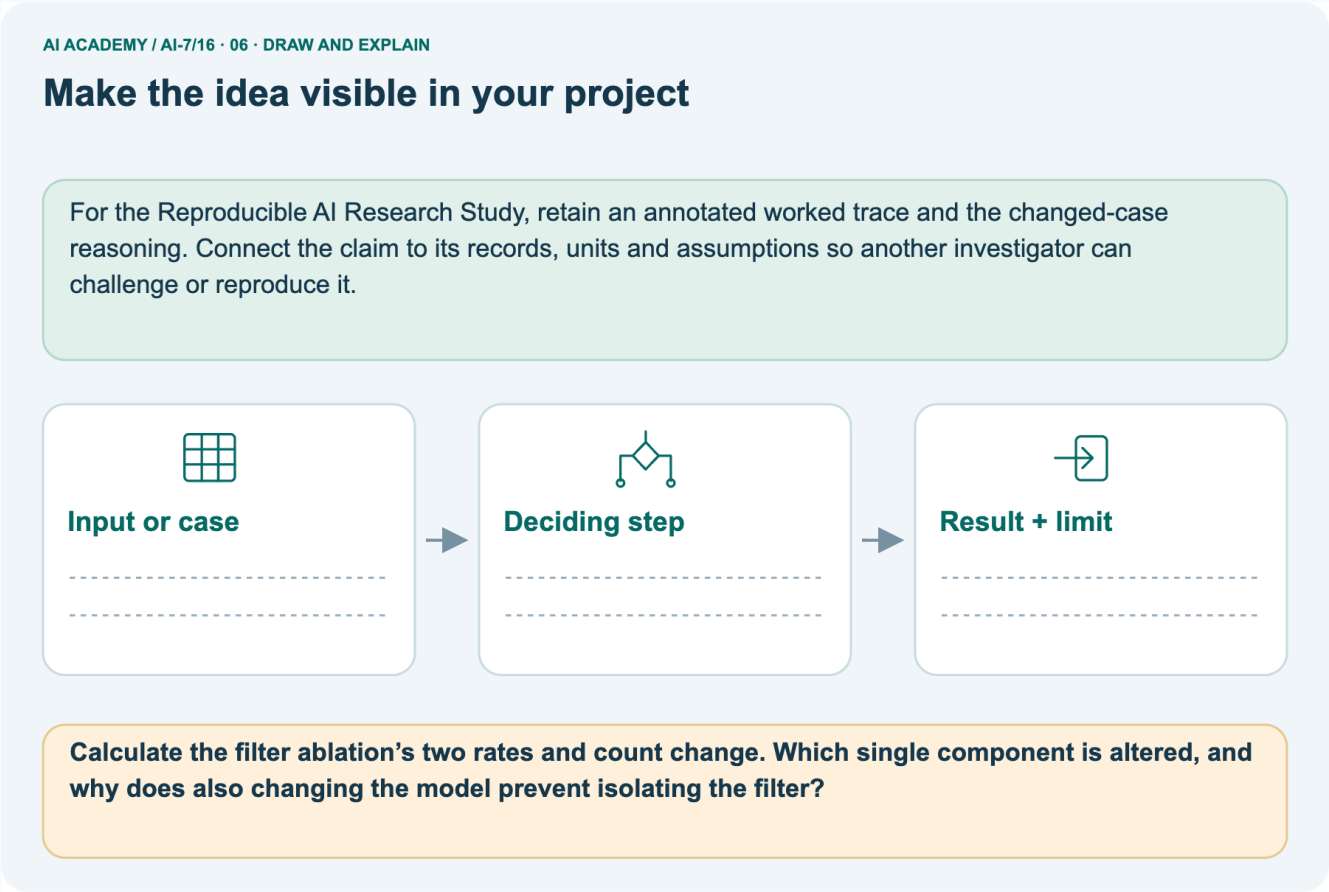
Explain the case, then point to a limit on the claim.

Discuss while showing the picture

Teacher prompt: Explain the case, then point to a limit on the claim. Ask learners to describe one label or arrow in ordinary words. Use the adjacent transcript if the image is difficult to see.

Keep the stated scope: **Interaction**s and small-sample variability remain; this illustrative difference is not a universal causal estimate.

06. Make the idea visible in your project



Follow the labelled picture with the matching explanation. Open the vector diagram

For the Reproducible AI Research Study, retain an annotated worked trace and the changed-case reasoning. Connect the claim to its records, units and assumptions so another investigator can challenge or reproduce it.

Draw your **input**, deciding step, result and limit. Supported question: Calculate the filter **ablation**'s two rates and count change.

Which single component is altered, and why does also changing the model prevent isolating the filter?

Draw your project trace and justify the deciding step using **evidence**.

Discuss while showing the picture

Teacher prompt: Draw your project trace and justify the deciding step using **evidence**. Ask learners to describe one label or arrow in ordinary words. Use the adjacent transcript if the image is difficult to see.

Supported practice key: The relevance filter is the single declared change. Remove only the filter and preserve cases and scoring. Correctness falls from **80%** to **60%**, two cases in this set.

Changed case: The comparison no longer isolates the filter. Two simultaneous changes provide alternative explanations.

Save or print your responses for your portfolio. Progress and drafts on the hosted website stay in the current browser. Use only fictional or teacher-approved data.